

# CHARTING NEW WATERS

## PARADIP PORT'S RISE AS INDIA'S CARGO LEADER

*With unparalleled cargo handling growth, cutting-edge digital solutions, and sustainability-driven expansion, Paradip Port is redefining India's maritime landscape. Sh. P L Haranadh, Chairman of PPA, discusses the port's innovative approach to multimodal logistics, green hydrogen initiatives, and future-ready infrastructure in this insightful Q&A:*

**Q. What key strategies have made Paradip Port India's top cargo-handling port, and how is technology enhancing its efficiency?**

Paradip Port's rise as India's leading cargo-handling port with 145.38 MMT in 2023-24 is driven by infrastructure expansion, multimodal connectivity, operational efficiency, and digital transformation. Moreover, capacity augmentation and enhanced rail-road connectivity have significantly improved Paradip Port's operational metrics, including Output per Ship Berth Day (OSBD), Turnaround Time (TRT), etc. Competitive tariffs and customer-centric policies further strengthen its position. To boost efficiency, PPA is integrating National Logistics Portal (NLP-Marine) for real-time tracking, deploying Enterprise Business System (EBS) for streamlined operations, and automating weighbridges and gates to reduce delays. The Vessel Traffic Management System (VTMIS) enhances real-time monitoring, ensuring faster, safer cargo movement

**Q. How is PPA enhancing its multimodal connectivity to improve cargo movement?**

Paradip Port Authority (PPA) is enhancing multimodal connectivity to ensure seamless cargo movement through major investments in rail, road, and inland waterways. The Haridaspur-Paradip second railway line and near-completed auto-signaling on the Cuttack-Paradip route have boosted cargo evacuation. On the road front, NH-53 (Chandikhol-Paradip) is being expanded into an 8-lane highway to ease congestion. PPA has also leveraged inland waterways, moving gypsum via the Mahanadi river mouth and signed an MoU to develop National Waterway 5 (NW-5).

The newly inaugurated Multimodal Logistics Park (MMLP) strengthens container movement, ensuring an integrated logistics ecosystem. As India's Coastal Cargo Hub, PPA handled 59.19 MMT of coastal cargo in FY 2023-24, accounting for 30% of major port coastal traffic, including significant thermal coal shipments to the western coast. Additionally, PPA is implementing innovative business strategies to further attract coastal cargo.

**Q. How is Paradip Port supporting India's Green Hydrogen and Ammonia initiatives while ensuring sustainability?**

Paradip Port Authority (PPA) is actively developing a Green Hydrogen and Ammonia Hub, signing MoUs with four investors committing ₹50,800 crore for production plants near the port. A dedicated green hydrogen and ammonia berth with 5 MTPA capacity is planned and set for award by 2026. To promote sustainability, PPA is undertaking key initiatives, including a Greenification Drive to plant one million trees, a transition to 100% mechanized cargo handling by 2030, and investments in renewable energy projects such as a 10 MW solar plant. Additionally, shore power supply and rail electrification will reduce emissions, reinforcing PPA's commitment to environmental stewardship.

**Q. How is Paradip Port leveraging Public-Private Partnerships (PPP) for expansion while strengthening its container handling capabilities?**

Public-Private Partnerships (PPPs) have been key in modernizing Paradip Port, improving efficiency, and increasing cargo capacity. Last year, PPP operators handled 41 MMT of cargo, achieving 74% berth occupancy. Moving forward, PPA is expanding partnerships for new berths, terminal operations, and digital solutions, aligning with its vision of a 100% landlord model. To boost container handling,



**Sh. P L Haranadh**
**Chairman**
Paradip Port Authority

PPA has developed a 5 MTPA Clean Cargo and Container Terminal under PPP. Competitive Vessel Related Charges (VRCs) with up to 75% discounts and direct connectivity to Colombo make PPA a cost-effective container hub. Additionally, PPA has commissioned a Multimodal Logistics Park (MMLP) in coordination with CONCOR and allocated land for two Container Freight Stations (CFSs) near the container berth.

**Q. Going forward, what is PPA's long-term vision?**

Paradip Port Authority (PPA) aims to surpass 400 MTPA cargo capacity by 2030 through major expansions, including the 25 MTPA Western Dock Project, development of three new berths, mechanization of four existing berths, and a dedicated green hydrogen berth. By 2047, under the Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision, PPA envisions becoming a world-class mega port with 500 MTPA capacity, integrating AI-driven automation, green energy solutions, and smart port technologies. A full transition to the landlord model will enhance efficiency through PPP investments. PPA's focus on sustainability, infrastructure expansion, and digital innovation will position it as a key driver in India's maritime growth.